

Halaa App

Testing Feedback

Hands-on session across signup, event creation, purchase and post-purchase

PRODUCT	Halaa mobile application (Arabic interface, iOS)
SESSION DATE	31 August 2026
TESTER	Internal — full journey walkthrough as a first-time paying customer
COVERAGE	Login and registration · Profile completion · Event creation · Date and calendar · File upload · Checkout and pricing · Add-ons · Support entry points · Arabic copy and typography
FINDINGS	19 (6 blockers, 8 significant, 5 refinements)
BASIS	Observed behaviour with screen captures; no code review performed

6 Blockers — stop or mislead a paying user	8 Significant — visible damage to trust or flow	5 Refinements — polish and consistency	7 Screen captures attached as evidence
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This document records what happened during a single end-to-end session, why each observation matters commercially, and what would resolve it. Nothing here is theoretical — every item was reproduced on a real device with a real purchase flow.

What the session showed

The product works. A first-time customer can register, build an event, pay and send invitations — and that is not a small thing. What the session exposed is a different class of problem: the app repeatedly makes the user doubt whether it is meant for them, whether the price is real, and whether anything is going to go wrong with their wedding.

Three patterns explain almost every finding below.

1. The app is priced in dollars in a Saudi product

Every price surface encountered during checkout displayed United States dollars — the plan total, the add-on catalogue, the order summary — while the line items inside the very same summary were written in riyals. A customer planning a wedding in Mecca, reading an Arabic interface, was asked to confirm `$149.99`. This is the single most damaging thing observed in the session, and it appears in more than one place, which means it is a configuration decision rather than an isolated bug.

2. The app speaks in three voices at once

Arabic interface, English error messages, Egyptian colloquial in a support dialogue, Gregorian dates in one place and Hijri in another, Arabic-Indic numerals in one line and Latin numerals directly beneath it. Individually each is minor. Together they read as an app assembled from parts, which is exactly the impression to avoid when asking someone to trust you with their guest list.

3. The app stops guiding the user at the moment they become a customer

After a successful purchase the flow does not advance — it presents another purchase screen. There is no visible invitation balance, no order tracking for a custom design that was paid for, and two support entry points that do nothing when tapped. The person most likely to need reassurance is the one who just paid, and that is precisely where the product goes quiet.

If only three things are fixed this week: set currency to SAR everywhere with the riyal symbol (F-07); route the user to their event — not to another shop — after payment (F-08); and fix the Arabic font so letters keep their dots (F-12). The first two protect revenue directly. The third is the first thing anyone notices and the cheapest to correct.

Findings at a glance

REF	FINDING	SEVERITY	AREA
F-01	Separate mobile number fields for login and registration	SIGNIFICANT	Authenticatio n
F-02	Username rules are invisible until rejection	BLOCKER	Onboarding

REF	FINDING	SEVERITY	AREA
F-03	Calendar cannot reach day 25 onward on mobile	BLOCKER	Event creation
F-04	Date picked in Gregorian is displayed back in Hijri	SIGNIFICANT	Event creation
F-05	Event creation takes an uncomfortably long time with no feedback	SIGNIFICANT	Event creation
F-06	"File too large" error when no file was uploaded	BLOCKER	Event creation
F-07	Prices shown in US dollars; riyal symbol absent; totals do not reconcile	BLOCKER	Payments
F-08	After purchase the user is offered another purchase	BLOCKER	Post-purchase
F-09	Support dialogue written in Egyptian colloquial Arabic	SIGNIFICANT	Content
F-10	"Contact us" button in that dialogue does nothing	SIGNIFICANT	Support
F-11	No visible invitation balance anywhere	SIGNIFICANT	Post-purchase
F-12	Custom design order cannot be tracked after payment	SIGNIFICANT	Post-purchase
F-13	Chat icon in the header leads nowhere	SIGNIFICANT	Support
F-14	Arabic text rendered without letter dots	BLOCKER	Typography
F-15	Numeral systems mixed within a single screen	REFINEMENT	Content
F-16	Error dialogue exposes a raw internal reference to the user	REFINEMENT	Error handling
F-17	Notification badge displays a count of zero	REFINEMENT	Navigation
F-18	Event name pre-filled in English inside an Arabic form	REFINEMENT	Event creation
F-19	Add-on wording implies purchases are lost when changing device	REFINEMENT	Payments

Blockers

Each of these either stops a customer from completing a task, or gives them information that is wrong. They should be treated as release-blocking.

F-07 Prices are shown in dollars, and the totals do not add up

BLOCKER

Order summary · Add-ons catalogue · Checkout

The order summary presents the Basic 200-invitation plan at \$149.99 and repeats \$149.99 as the amount payable at the bottom of the screen. Directly above that, the selected extras are itemised in riyals: ٢٠٠٠ — ٥٠٠+ دعوات إضافية and ٢٠٠ — تصميم الدعوة. The add-ons catalogue is priced entirely in dollars, from \$9.99 to \$299.99. The riyal symbol does not appear anywhere in the checkout.

Two separate problems are stacked here. The first is that a Saudi customer is being quoted a foreign currency for a domestic service. The second is worse: the itemised extras total 2,200 SAR, which is roughly 586 dollars, yet the amount payable reads 149.99 dollars. Whatever the underlying logic, the screen as presented does not reconcile, and a careful buyer will notice before they pay rather than after.

Why this matters commercially. Currency confusion at checkout is one of the highest-abandonment moments in any purchase. Here it also creates a genuine dispute risk: if the charge that lands on the card differs from the figure the customer read, the operator carries that argument, and the store handling the refund will side with the customer.

What to do.

- Set SAR as the display currency for all Saudi users and render the official riyal symbol rather than a dollar sign or the word.
 - Make the summary arithmetic visible and correct: base plan, each add-on, subtotal, VAT, total payable — every line in the same currency.
 - If store-level pricing tiers are the source of the dollar figures, map each tier to its riyal equivalent and display the riyal figure, not the tier default.
 - Show VAT explicitly. A Saudi customer expects to see it stated.
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How to verify. Complete one purchase of each plan and each add-on, and confirm that the figure shown on screen, the figure in the store confirmation, and the figure on the card statement are identical.

8:46

ملخص الطلب

\$149.99

هلا بيسك 200 دعوة
مناسبة واحدة

2- دعوة أساسية

0+ دعوة إضافية

مناسبة واحدة

3- دعوة ترويجية

730

إجمالي الدعوات

إجمالي الرصيد = الدعوات الأساسية + الباقات الإضافية + ترويجي 115.
+10: دعوات إضافية مجانية على دعوات باقاتك الأساسية. الباقات الإضافية
لا تدخل على الترويجي.
بالقوة لكل مناسبة، مناسبة واحدة بهذا المبلغ من الدعوات.

الإضافات المختارة

رأس 2000

دعوات إضافية +0

رأس 200

تصميم الدعوة

الجمالي

\$149.99

تفعيل الاشتراك

Order summary. Plan and total in dollars; selected extras in riyals; the two do not reconcile. Numerals are also mixed — ٢٠٠ دعوة أساسية — 2000 ر.س

F-08 Buying invitations leads to another screen selling invitations

BLOCKER

Immediately after purchase confirmation

Having bought a plan, the next screen presented was the add-ons catalogue — thirteen further invitation bundles with a purchase button beside each. The instruction at the top reads أكمل شراء الإضافات التي اخترتها. كل إضافة عملية شراء منفصلة.

The user has just given the product money. The natural next thought is "now let me add my guests" or "let me see my invitation". Instead the app asks for money again. Even where a second purchase is genuinely required by the store's in-app purchase model, the screen does not explain that — it simply looks like an upsell placed in front of a customer who has already converted.

Why this matters commercially. This is the moment of highest goodwill in the entire relationship, and it is being spent on a second sales pitch instead of on progress. It also produces support load, because the customer cannot tell whether their first payment succeeded.

What to do.

- After a successful payment, land the user on their event with a clear confirmation: what they bought, how many invitations they now hold, and the single next action — add guests.
- If additional purchases must be completed separately, say so plainly before the first payment, not after it, and show progress ("1 of 2 purchases complete").
- Move the add-ons catalogue to a place the user chooses to visit, not a place they are pushed into.



The screen presented after payment: thirteen further bundles, each priced in dollars, each requiring a separate transaction.

F-03 The calendar cannot reach the end of the month on mobile

BLOCKER

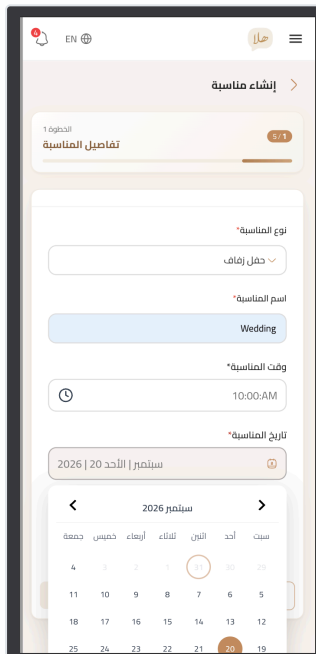
Event creation, step 1 – event date

On a phone, the date picker opens beneath the field and the final row of the month is cut off by the edge of the viewport. Days from 25 onward could not be selected. The picker does not scroll into view and the sheet does not resize.

Roughly a fifth of all possible dates are therefore unreachable on the primary device for this product. Weddings are commonly held at month end.

What to do. Present the picker as a bottom sheet on small screens, sized to the content and scrolled into view on open, with the confirm action pinned. Test at the smallest supported height rather than on a large device.

How to verify. On the smallest supported screen, open the picker from the lowest position the field can occupy in the form and confirm that days 25 to 31 are both visible and tappable.



The calendar as it appears on a phone. The row containing 25 to 31 is clipped by the viewport.

F-06 "File too large" — for a file that was never uploaded

BLOCKER

Event creation, final review and save

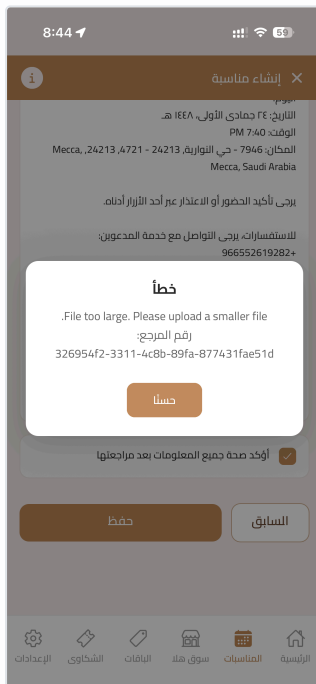
On saving the event, an error dialogue appeared reading `File too large. Please upload a smaller file.` followed by a reference identifier. No file had been selected at any point in the flow. The save did not complete.

Three faults are visible in one dialogue. The event cannot be created, so the user is blocked outright. The message describes something the user did not do, so it offers no route forward. And the message is in English inside an Arabic interface, with the sentence-ending period rendered at the start of the line — a text-direction fault that makes it look broken as well as wrong.

Likely cause worth checking first. A default or template image being submitted with the event payload, or a request size limit being reported as a file size error. The reference identifier in the dialogue should map directly to the failing request in the server logs.

What to do.

- Fix the underlying failure so that an event with no uploaded design saves successfully.
- Translate every error message and wrap Latin text so that punctuation renders on the correct side.
- Where a size limit genuinely applies, state it ("Maximum 5 MB") and name the file concerned.
- Never lose the user's work. If a save fails, the form must retain everything they entered.



The error as presented: English text, misplaced punctuation, an internal reference identifier, and no available action other than dismissal.

F-14 Arabic text is rendering without its dots

BLOCKER

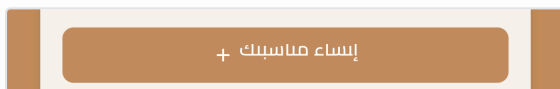
Multiple screens, including the primary action button

Arabic letters are losing their diacritical dots in several places. The main call to action reads as إنشاء ماسك where it should read إنشاء ماسبتك — the ن, ب and ت forms all appear undotted.

In Arabic the dots are not decoration; they are what distinguishes one letter from another. Text without them is not stylised, it is unreadable, and it reads to a native speaker as a product that was not built by anyone who reads the language. This is the first thing a Saudi user will notice, and it sits on the button they are meant to press first.

Likely cause worth checking first. A font that was subset for Latin coverage and stripped of the Arabic mark glyphs, or a font weight in the family that lacks full Arabic support and is being substituted silently. Check every weight actually used, not only the regular.

What to do. Standardise on a single Arabic family with verified coverage across all weights used in the app, and remove font subsetting for the Arabic ranges. Then read every screen in Arabic on a real device before release.



The primary action button. Every dotted letter has lost its dots.

F-02 Username rules are invisible until the form rejects you

BLOCKER

Complete profile, after registration

The username field does not state what it will accept. The rules — permitted characters, minimum and maximum length, whether spaces or Arabic are allowed, whether the name must be unique — only become apparent through repeated rejection.

This sits in the profile completion step, which every new account must pass through. A user who has just registered and is being refused without explanation is a user who may not return, and the cost of that refusal falls entirely on an account that has already been acquired.

What to do.

- State the rules beneath the field before anything is typed, in plain language.
- Validate as the user types and show which requirements are already satisfied.
- Where the name is taken, say so specifically and suggest two available alternatives.
- Consider whether a username is needed at all. If the account is identified by mobile number, this field may be removable — the fastest fix available.

Significant issues

These do not stop the journey, but each one visibly costs trust or forces the user to work around the product.

F-09 The support dialogue speaks Egyptian, to a Saudi customer

SIGNIFICANT

Modal shown during event creation

A dialogue offering managed service reads: دعوتك علينا — ممكن تبعطنا كل التفاصيل، واحنا هنخليك كل الخطوات سهلة وبسيطة! The construction تبعطنا, the pronoun احنا, and the future marker هنخليك are Egyptian colloquial. A Saudi customer will place the dialect immediately.

The user's own note on this screen was a question — "is this app targeting Egypt?" — which is exactly the doubt it creates. For a product built around Saudi weddings and family events, sounding foreign at the moment you offer help is a meaningful loss.

What to do. Rewrite in Saudi-neutral Arabic, for example: مناسبتك علينا — أرسل لنا التفاصيل ونتولى عنك كل الخطوات. Then review every string in the app for dialect, since a phrase written this way is rarely the only one. Replace the generic telephone clip-art with brand illustration while you are there.



The dialogue as shown. Dialect aside, the primary button did not respond when tapped — see F-10.

F-10 The "contact us" button in that dialogue does nothing

SIGNIFICANT

Same modal

Tapping تواصل معنا produced no response. The dialogue remained open with no navigation, no WhatsApp handoff and no error.

The offer being made is help. The button that accepts the offer is inert. Whatever the customer's problem was at that moment, it is now unresolved and their impression of the support function is set.

What to do. Wire the button to WhatsApp with a prefilled message containing the account and event reference, so the agent knows who is writing before they reply. If the destination is not ready, remove the dialogue rather than ship a promise the app cannot keep.

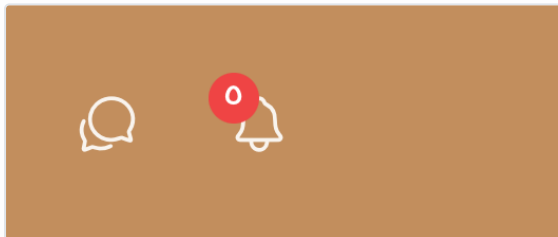
F-13 The chat icon in the header leads nowhere

SIGNIFICANT

Global header, beside the notification bell

The chat bubble in the top bar is present on every screen and does not respond to taps. It is the most visible support affordance in the app and it is not connected to anything.

What to do. Connect it to the same WhatsApp handoff as F-10, or remove it. A support control that visibly fails is worse than none at all, because the user concludes that support itself is unavailable.



Header controls. The chat bubble is inert; the bell carries a badge reading zero — see F-17.

F-11 There is no way to see how many invitations you hold

SIGNIFICANT

Home, event view, account

The remaining invitation balance is not displayed anywhere. The only way to discover it is to begin inviting someone and observe whether the app permits it.

This is the number the customer paid for. It is the one figure they will want to check most often, particularly while a guest list is still growing, and it is the natural trigger for buying more. Hiding it costs the user confidence and the operator revenue at the same time.

What to do.

- Show the balance persistently — home screen and event header: "142 of 200 invitations remaining".
- Break it down: sent, accepted, declined, awaiting reply, plus compensation credits held separately.
- Place a quiet "add more" action beside it. That is where an upsell belongs, rather than after checkout.

F-12 A paid custom design cannot be tracked

SIGNIFICANT

After purchasing the design add-on (200 SAR)

Having paid for invitation design, there is no order record, no status, no expected delivery time and no way to reach the designer. The transaction completes and then disappears from the customer's view.

This is a service the customer is waiting on, for a dated event. Silence here generates support contacts within a day and refund requests within a week.

What to do.

- Create a visible order record with a status trail: received, in design, ready for review, approved.
- State a delivery commitment at the point of purchase and repeat it on the order.
- Notify on each status change, and allow the customer to message about that specific order.

F-04 The date is chosen in Gregorian and returned in Hijri

SIGNIFICANT

Event creation, date field · Invitation preview

The calendar presents Gregorian months and days, but once a date is chosen it is displayed back in Hijri — the invitation preview shows ٢٤ جمادى الأولى، ١٤٤٨ هـ. The user selects one thing and is shown another.

Both calendars are legitimate and both are used in Saudi Arabia. The problem is that the app never confirms which one the guest will see. For a wedding date, that ambiguity is not a detail the customer will be relaxed about.

What to do.

- Show both calendars wherever a date appears: ٢٠ سبتمبر ٢٠٢٦ — ٢٤ جمادى الأولى ١٤٤٨ هـ.
- Let the user choose which appears first on the invitation, and preview it exactly as the guest will receive it.
- Keep the picker and the confirmation in the same calendar so the selection is never surprising.

F-05 Creating an event takes a long time, in silence

SIGNIFICANT

Event creation, save

The save step is slow enough to be noticeable, with no indication of progress and no confirmation of what is happening. Combined with F-06, the user is left waiting and then told something failed for a reason that does not apply to them.

What to do.

- Measure the server time for the save call and address whatever dominates it — image processing is the usual candidate.
- Until it is fast, show honest progress: "Saving your event", then "Preparing your invitation", with the action disabled to prevent double submission.
- Set a timeout with a retry that preserves everything the user entered.

F-01 Login and registration use separate mobile number fields

SIGNIFICANT

Authentication

The two flows implement their own mobile inputs, with the formatting, country prefix handling and validation defined separately in each. A number accepted in one place may be rejected or normalised differently in the other.

For a product where the mobile number *is* the account, two implementations of the same field is a defect waiting to surface as "I registered but I cannot log in" — the most expensive support ticket there is, because the customer has already paid attention and is now stuck at the door.

What to do. Extract one phone input component and use it in both flows: identical mask, identical country handling, identical validation, identical error text. Normalise to E.164 at the boundary so the stored value is unambiguous.

Refinements

Small individually. Collectively they are the difference between an app that feels finished and one that does not.

F-15 Numerals switch systems within a single screen

REFINEMENT

Order summary, event details, throughout

The order summary shows ٢٠٠ دعوة أساسية and ٧٣٠ in Arabic-Indic numerals, then ٢٠٠٠ ر.س and \$149.99 in Latin numerals a few lines below. The same inconsistency appears on the website.

What to do. Pick one system and apply it everywhere. Latin numerals are the convention in Saudi digital products and match what payment providers return, which makes them the practical choice. Set it once in a shared formatting layer rather than per screen.

F-16 Error dialogues expose internal references

REFINEMENT

Error dialogue, event save

The failure dialogue displayed 326954f2-3311-4c8b-89fa-877431fae51d beneath the message. To the customer this is noise, and it makes a routine failure look like a system crash.

What to do. Keep the reference — it is genuinely useful for support — but present it quietly: a short code beneath a plain-language message, with a copy action, and the full identifier logged rather than displayed. Lead with what the user should do next, not with the identifier.

F-17 The notification badge shows zero

REFINEMENT

Global header

The bell carries a red badge displaying 0. A badge exists to signal that something is waiting; a badge showing zero trains the user to ignore badges entirely.

What to do. Hide the badge when the count is zero, and cap the display at 9+.

F-18 The event name is pre-filled in English

REFINEMENT

Event creation, step 1

With the event type set to حفل زفاف, the name field was pre-filled with the English word "Wedding" in an otherwise Arabic form. The default does not follow the interface language.

What to do. Localise defaults with the interface, or leave the field empty with a helpful placeholder such as مثال: زواج أحمد ونورة, which also shows the user what a good event name looks like.

F-19 Add-on wording raises a question it does not answer

REFINEMENT

Add-ons catalogue

The catalogue states الإضافات الاستهلاكية وباقات المناسبات تُطبَّق على حسابك ولا يمكن استعادتها على جهاز آخر. The phrasing describes a store restriction in store language, and a customer reading it will reasonably worry that switching phones costs them what they paid for.

What to do. Say what is actually true from the customer's point of view: purchases are attached to the Halaa account and are available on any device after signing in. If a genuine device restriction exists, state its practical consequence plainly before purchase rather than in small print after it.

Two things worth keeping

Worth saying explicitly, because a list of defects can give a misleading impression of the whole. The five-step event creation flow is well structured — the progress indicator, the step summaries and the ability to send yourself a test message are genuinely good product decisions, and the test-message step in particular is the kind of reassurance most competitors do not offer. The bottom navigation is also clear and correctly ordered for the tasks it serves.

PART 4

Suggested order of work

Sequenced by what a customer feels first, and by what protects money already being spent.

This week

REF	ACTION	EFFORT
F-14	Fix the Arabic font so letters keep their dots; audit every weight in use	Hours
F-07	Display SAR with the riyal symbol everywhere; make the summary arithmetic reconcile; show VAT	1–2 days
F-06	Fix the false "file too large" failure and translate the message	1 day
F-03	Make the calendar reachable to day 31 on the smallest supported screen	Hours
F-13, F-10	Connect the chat icon and the contact button, or remove them	Hours
F-17	Hide the notification badge at zero	Minutes

Next two weeks

REF	ACTION	EFFORT
F-08	Route the user to their event after payment, with a clear confirmation and one next action	2–3 days
F-11	Show the invitation balance persistently, with a breakdown	2–3 days
F-02	State username rules inline, or remove the field	1 day
F-09	Rewrite all dialect strings in Saudi-neutral Arabic; full string review	1–2 days
F-04	Show Hijri and Gregorian together; preview the invitation as the guest sees it	2 days
F-01	Single shared phone input across login and registration	1 day
F-15	One numeral system, applied through a shared formatter	1 day

Following month

REF	ACTION	EFFORT
F-12	Order tracking for custom design, with status trail and delivery commitment	1 week

REF	ACTION	EFFORT
F-05	Reduce event save time; add honest progress states and safe retry	3–4 days
F-16, F-18, F-19	Error presentation, localised defaults, add-on wording	2 days

One suggestion beyond the list. Most of these were found in a single sitting by one person walking the journey end to end as a customer. A recurring session of exactly that kind — buy a real plan, on a real phone, in Arabic, once per release — would catch this class of issue before customers do. The currency and font findings in particular are the sort that only surface when someone actually reaches checkout with intent to pay.

Prepared from a testing session on 31 August 2026. Seven screen captures are attached inline as evidence. Severity reflects impact on a paying customer rather than technical complexity.